

Twelve-Month Dossier II — International, Reports, Science, Defence and Sport

Chapter F10.4 — August 2025 to 1 August 2026, With the Low-Yield Sections Kept Short
on Purpose



Module	Foundation Layer — Module 10 — Integrated Current Affairs
Chapter	Chapter F10.4
Topic	Official syllabus head — Current Events and Developmental Issues
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NOTE · WHY THIS CHAPTER GETS SHORTER AS IT GOES ON

F10.3 covered the half of the dossier that bears directly on this post. This chapter covers the rest, and it is arranged in **descending order of yield**, which means the sections get shorter as you read.

Section	Length	Why
§1 International, §2 Reports	Full	Attribution questions are permanent and cheap — F10.1 §1.1's <i>kind 1</i>
§3 Science, §4 Defence	Moderate	Attaches to Module 9, and defence items are definite
§5 Awards, sport, persons	Deliberately compact	The largest part of a commercial current affairs magazine and close to zero of this paper

§5 is short as a decision, not an oversight. F10.1 §1.2 records the reasoning: sport, entertainment, obituaries and general trivia do not attach to the static syllabus, and an item that attaches to nothing is an item to discard. What §5 contains is the handful of results a general-awareness question would most plausibly use, and nothing more.

If you find yourself spending longer on §5 than on §1 and §2, you are revising the wrong chapter.

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0. How This Chapter Works

STUDY SESSION · CHAPTER F10.4

1. **Session 1** — International relations and summits (§1) ★★★★★
2. **Session 2** — Reports, indices and India's rank (§2) ★★★★★
3. **Session 3** — Science, space and technology (§3) ★★★★★
4. **Session 4** — Defence and security (§4) ★★★★★
5. **Session 5** — Awards, sport and persons (§5) ★★★★★

Then **35 graded questions in §6**. Budget **one evening** for the whole chapter — it is a record to be read and drilled, not a body of theory to be learned.

1. Session 1 — International Relations and Summits ★★★★★

1.1 COP30, Belém

Item	Position
Venue and dates	Belém, Brazil, 10 to 21 November 2025, concluding 22 November
Principal decision	The " Global Mutirão " decision — <i>mutirão</i> being a Brazilian term for collective effort
Occasion	The tenth anniversary of the Paris Agreement
Finance	Agreement calling for a tripling of funding for developing countries to adapt to climate impacts
Fossil fuels	No clear commitment to transition away from fossil fuels in the main decision — the principal criticism of the outcome
Separate instrument	A " Belém Declaration ", led by Colombia , in which a coalition of countries committed to a just and orderly transition away from fossil fuels
Other outcomes	Global indicators for adaptation ; a just transition mechanism ; a new Gender Action Plan ; a three-year dialogue on trade
Context	2024 confirmed as the warmest year on record, about 1.55 °C above pre-industrial levels

Sources: United Nations on the COP30 outcome · UN News on the finance package and the absence of a fossil fuel commitment · IISD summary of the negotiations

TRAP · THE MUTIRÃO DECISION AND THE BELÉM DECLARATION ARE DIFFERENT THINGS

This is the most likely confusion in the whole section, and it is a clean four-option question.

- The **Global Mutirão decision** is the **formal COP30 outcome**, adopted by the conference. It contains the

finance package — and **does not** commit parties to move away from fossil fuels

- The **Belém Declaration** is a **separate, voluntary political declaration** led by **Colombia**, signed by

a coalition rather than by the COP, which **does** address transition away from fossil fuels

So an option stating that COP30 agreed to phase out fossil fuels is wrong, and an option stating that no country committed to it is also wrong. The distinction is between what the conference decided and what a coalition declared alongside it. *Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

1.2 The G20

Item	Position
Summit	Johannesburg, South Africa, 22 and 23 November 2025
Presidency	South Africa — the first African country to chair the G20 , holding the presidency from 1 December 2024 to November 2025
Philosophy invoked	Ubuntu , the African conception of shared responsibility and interconnectedness; solidarity, equality and sustainability as pillars
Outcomes in which India's priorities are visible	Condemnation of terrorism in all its forms ; recognition of Digital Public Infrastructure ; women-led development ; disaster resilience; commitments on food security, health and climate finance
2026 presidency	The United States — the summit is to be held at Miami

Sources: G20 South Africa Leaders' Declaration · Economic Times on India's priorities in the Declaration · G20 2026 presidency

Two facts worth holding beyond the venue: South Africa was the first African chair, and **Digital Public Infrastructure** — an Indian export in policy terms — was recognised in the Declaration. *Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

1.3 Trade and mobility

Covered in F10.3 §4.2 and §1.5, and listed here because the international dimension is where a question may place them:

- **India-UK CETA** — signed **24 July 2025**, in force **15 July 2026**, **30 chapters**
- **India-UK Double Contributions Convention** — in force **15 July 2026**, exemption up to **60 months**
- **India-EU Free Trade Agreement** — **concluded 27 January 2026**, after nearly two decades of negotiation

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 1

1. Give COP30's venue, dates and the name of its principal decision
2. Distinguish the Global Mutirão decision from the Belém Declaration
3. What did COP30 agree on finance, and what did it not agree on?
4. Give the G20 summit's venue and dates, and why South Africa's presidency was a first
5. Which philosophy did the Johannesburg Declaration invoke, and who holds the 2026 presidency?

2. Session 2 — Reports, Indices and India's Rank ★★★★★

2.1 Why this section matters more than its length suggests

F10.1 §1.1 classifies current affairs questions into three kinds and identifies **institutional attribution** as the highest-yield kind, because the answer is permanent. **F10.1 §2.2's report-to-publisher table is the material to learn.** What follows adds the **rankings** published inside the dossier window.

2.2 The World Happiness Report 2026

Item	Position
India's rank	116th , an improvement from 118th in 2025
Countries covered	147
First	Finland , for the ninth consecutive year
Note	India placed behind both Nepal and Pakistan
Published by	The UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network
Drivers identified	Income, social support, freedom of choice; and a link between social media use and youth well-being

Sources: The Hindu on the 2026 rankings · Economic Times on India's rise to 116th

The examinable trio is 116th, 147 countries, and Finland ninth time. *Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

2.3 Other rankings in the window

IMPORTANT · THESE FIGURES COME FROM A COMPILATION, NOT FROM THE PUBLISHING BODIES

The rankings below are taken from a **coaching compilation** of 2026 indices, not from the primary reports. They are included because the dossier is meant to be exhaustive, but they carry **a weaker guarantee than anything else in these two chapters**, and the register records that distinction in §8.4.

Index	India's reported rank
Global Innovation Index	38th
Corruption Perceptions Index	96th
Environmental Performance Index	176th of 177
Henley Passport Index	75th
Global Terrorism Index	13th

Source: compilation of India's 2026 index rankings

Verify any of these against the publishing body before relying on it, and note that ranks move with methodology as well as with performance. **The publisher of each index is the durable fact and the rank is not** — which is why §6's questions test publishers rather than these numbers. F10.1 §2.2 has the publisher table. *Content rephrased from the source for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

2.4 The Indian statistical releases

Release	Position
Economic Survey 2025-26	Real GDP growth for 2025-26 at 7.4% in the First Advance Estimates; 6.8% to 7.2% projected for 2026-27
GDP base year	Revised from 2011-12 to 2022-23
Periodic Labour Force Survey	Now released monthly , as well as quarterly and annually
Unemployment and participation	Unemployment about 5.1% ; LFPR about 54-55% ; female LFPR about 34%
Total fertility rate	Below replacement — 1.9 on the SRS, 2.0 on NFHS-6, against a replacement level of 2.1

All with sources in **F4.1 §3.1**, **F4.4 §2.2** and **F4.5 §1.3**.

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 2

1. Give India's rank, the number of countries, and the leader in the World Happiness Report 2026
2. Which body publishes it? Which publishes the Global Innovation Index?
3. Why are the §2.3 rankings marked as carrying a weaker guarantee?
4. Give the Economic Survey's growth estimate and projection, and the revised base year

3. Session 3 — Science, Space and Technology ★★★★★

3.1 NISAR — the preceding anchor

KNOW · LAUNCHED 30 JULY 2025, TWO DAYS BEFORE THE WINDOW OPENS

NISAR — the NASA-ISRO Synthetic Aperture Radar — was launched on **30 July 2025** aboard **GSLV-F16**. That is **two days before this dossier's window begins**, and it is included because it is the most significant Indian space event adjacent to the period and because a paper set in 2026 may still ask about it.

Item	Position
Significance	The first joint ISRO–NASA satellite mission
Technical first	The first dual-frequency (L-band and S-band) radar Earth observation satellite
Configuration	NASA's 12-metre unfurlable antenna integrated on an Indian satellite bus , launched on an Indian launch vehicle
Purpose	Global microwave imaging using fully polarimetric and interferometric data

Sources: PIB on NISAR's dual-frequency radar · ISRO on the mission as a first joint ISRO-NASA venture

Two things are asked about NISAR: that it is **joint ISRO–NASA**, and that it is **dual-frequency L and S band**. *Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

3.2 The 2025 Nobel Prizes

Prize	Laureates	For
Physiology or Medicine	Mary E. Brunkow, Fred Ramsdell, Shimon Sakaguchi	Discoveries concerning peripheral immune tolerance — how the body restrains its own immune system
Physics	John Clarke, Michel H. Devoret, John M. Martinis	Macroscopic quantum mechanical tunnelling and energy quantisation in an electric circuit
Chemistry	Susumu Kitagawa, Richard Robson, Omar M. Yaghi	The development of metal-organic frameworks
Literature	László Krasznahorkai (Hungary)	A visionary body of work affirming the power of art
Peace	María Corina Machado (Venezuela)	Democratic opposition work
Economic Sciences	Joel Mokyr, Philippe Aghion, Peter Howitt	Explaining how innovation drives sustained growth

Sources: Nobel Prize in Physics 2025 · Nobel Prize in Literature 2025 · all 2025 prizes · Yahoo/AP summary of the Peace and Economics prizes

KNOW · THE TWO THAT CONNECT TO MODULE 9, AND THE ONE THAT CONNECTS TO MODULE 4

Nobel questions are usually pure recall, but three of these attach to the static syllabus, which per F10.1 §1.2 is what makes them worth learning:

- **Chemistry — metal-organic frameworks** are porous crystalline materials with very large internal surface

area, used for gas storage and separation. This is F9.3's chemistry

- **Physics — macroscopic quantum tunnelling** in a superconducting circuit is the physical basis of

superconducting **qubits**, and therefore of quantum computing. F9.2 and F9.5

- **Economics — innovation-driven growth** is endogenous growth theory, which is the theoretical answer to

F4.1 §3.2's distinction between growth and development

László Krasznahorkai is the second Hungarian laureate in Literature, after Imre Kertész in 2002. *Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 3

1. Give NISAR's launch date, launch vehicle, and its two claims to being a first
2. Name the 2025 Physics laureates and what they were recognised for
3. What were the 2025 Chemistry and Economics prizes awarded for?
4. Who won the 2025 prizes for Literature and for Peace?

4. Session 4 — Defence and Security ★★☆☆☆

4.1 Operation Sindoor and what followed

Item	Position
Operation Sindoor	Indian strikes on terror infrastructure in Pakistan , conducted in May 2025
Platforms and weapons	Rafale, Sukhoi-30MKI and Tejas aircraft; Meteor beyond-visual-range air-to-air missiles; BrahMos ; SCALP cruise missiles; S-400 air defence
Confirmation	The Indian Air Force released footage in January 2026 showing Rafale aircraft armed with Meteor , ending public speculation
Republic Day 2026	India's 77th Republic Day; a ' Sindoor ' formation flypast over Kartavya Path

4.2 Acquisitions cleared in the window

Item	Position
Rafale	The Defence Acquisition Council cleared a deal valued at about €32 billion for 114 aircraft , of which 90 are to be built in India with 50% indigenous content, integrating BrahMos and Astra
SCALP	A deal with France worth about €300 million (about US\$356 million) for 100 to 150 long-range air-launched cruise missiles
S-400	Additional missiles for the Russian-supplied air defence system approved
Mission Sudarshan Chakra	An advanced air defence programme under development

Sources: Economic Times on post-Sindoor capability expansion · Times of India on the IAF's Meteor footage · Times Now on the 114-Rafale clearance · Times of India on the SCALP deal

Note the status distinction, again. These are **clearances and advanced negotiations**, not deliveries. F10.2 §2.2's four stages — proposed, approved, contracted, delivered — apply as much to defence procurement as to a wage ceiling, and an option asserting that 114 Rafales have been **inducted** is wrong. *Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 4

1. What was Operation Sindoor, and when was it conducted?
2. Which beyond-visual-range missile was confirmed on IAF Rafales, and when?
3. Give the number of Rafale aircraft cleared, and how many are to be built in India
4. What is SCALP, and what is the approximate value of the deal?
5. Which Republic Day was 2026?

5. Session 5 — Awards, Sport and Persons ★★☆☆☆

Compact by decision. See §0.

5.1 Padma Awards 2026

Item	Position
Total	131 awards , including two duo cases (a duo counted as one)
Composition	5 Padma Vibhushan, 13 Padma Bhushan, 113 Padma Shri
Among the recipients	19 women , 6 in the foreign/NRI/PIO/OCI category, 16 posthumous
Notable	Dharmendra — Padma Vibhushan, posthumously , received by Hema Malini; also Mammooty, Alka Yagnik, Rohit Sharma, Uday Kotak, Mamidala Jagadesh Kumar, V. Kamakoti
Announced	Republic Day 2026
Conferred	The President conferred 66 of the awards on 25 May 2026

Sources: The Hindu full list and composition · The Hindu on the conferment ceremony

The examinable numbers are 131, and 5 / 13 / 113. *Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

5.2 Sport

ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2026

Item	Position
Final	India beat New Zealand by 96 runs , on 8 March 2026
Significance	India's third T20 World Cup title; the first team to win two consecutive titles; the first host country to win the tournament
Next edition	2028 , in Australia and New Zealand

Source: 2026 Men's T20 World Cup final

Commonwealth Games 2026, Glasgow — the 23rd Games

Item	Position
India's placing	Fourth
India's medals	39 in total — 13 gold, 17 silver, 9 bronze
Context	India's lowest tally in 24 years , and the first time below 50 medals since Kuala Lumpur in 1998
Ahead of India	Australia (171 medals, 70 gold), England (110, 29), Canada (62, 19)
India's best sport	Boxing — 10 medals including 7 gold , the most by any nation in boxing at a single Commonwealth Games
Individual firsts	Tejaswin Shankar , first Indian to win a Commonwealth Games decathlon medal; Gulveer Singh , first Indian to win two athletics medals at a single Games

Sources: The Hindu final medal tally · Sporting News on the standings

IMPORTANT · THE GAMES CLOSED ONE DAY AFTER THE CUT-OFF

The Glasgow Commonwealth Games **concluded on 2 August 2026 — one day after this dossier's stated cut-off of 1 August 2026.**

The Games are included, and the straddle is stated, because §0 of F10.3 commits the dossier to applying the cut-off strictly and **declaring** rather than concealing the edge cases. **The final medal tally is therefore a 2 August figure**, even though the great majority of the competition falls inside the window.

If your examination's own cut-off is stated as 1 August 2026, a question on the **final** tally would be outside it — but questions are rarely that precise, and the tally is worth knowing either way. *Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

5.3 Persons

Item	Position
Vice President	C.P. Radhakrishnan , 15th, from 12 September 2025 — F10.3 §3.1
Chief Justice of India	Justice Surya Kant , 53rd, from 24 November 2025 — F10.3 §3.2
Central Provident Fund Commissioner	Ramesh Krishnamurthi — F10.3 §1.3
Union Minister for Labour and Employment	Mansukh Mandaviya , who also holds Youth Affairs and Sports
RBI Governor	Sanjay Malhotra — F4.2 §2.1
Sixteenth Finance Commission Chairman	Arvind Panagariya — F4.3 §4.1
NITI Aayog CEO	B.V.R. Subrahmanyam — F10.3 §4.1
Census Commissioner	Mritunjay Kumar Narayan — F4.5 §2.3

Deaths in the period are not tabulated. F10.1 §1.2 places obituaries outside the attachment points that make a current affairs item worth learning, and the dossier follows that judgement rather than padding. **The one death with an examinable consequence** is that of the actor **Dharmendra**, whose Padma Vibhushan in 2026 was conferred **posthumously** — §5.1.

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 5

1. Give the total number of Padma Awards for 2026 and the split between the three grades
2. Who received the Padma Vibhushan posthumously?
3. Give the T20 World Cup 2026 result, margin and India's three firsts
4. Give India's placing, medal total and best sport at the 2026 Commonwealth Games
5. Name the CPFC, the Labour Minister and the RBI Governor

6. Graded Practice — 35 Questions ★★★★★

Target: 20 to 30 seconds each.

6.1 International

- Q1.** COP30 was held at (a) Baku (b) Belém (c) Dubai (d) Sharm el-Sheikh
- Q2.** The principal decision adopted at COP30 was named (a) the Baku Package (b) the Glasgow Climate Pact (c) the Paris Rulebook (d) the Global Mutirão decision
- Q3.** COP30 coincided with the Paris Agreement's (a) tenth anniversary (b) fifth anniversary (c) twentieth anniversary (d) fifteenth anniversary
- Q4.** The G20 summit of November 2025 was held at (a) New Delhi (b) Rio de Janeiro (c) Johannesburg (d) Bali
- Q5.** South Africa's G20 presidency was notable because it was (a) the first time an African country chaired the forum (b) the first time a BRICS member chaired it (c) the shortest presidency on record (d) the first from which observers were excluded
- Q6.** The G20 presidency for 2026 is held by (a) Brazil (b) India (c) the United States (d) France
- Q7.** The African philosophy emphasised in the Johannesburg Leaders' Declaration was (a) Harambee (b) Sankofa (c) Négritude (d) Ubuntu
- Q8.** The India–United Kingdom trade agreement entered into force alongside (a) a double taxation avoidance agreement (b) the Double Contributions Convention (c) a defence procurement pact (d) a migration and mobility partnership

6.2 Reports and indices

- Q9.** In the World Happiness Report 2026 India was ranked (a) 126th (b) 118th (c) 108th (d) 116th
- Q10.** The country ranked happiest for the ninth consecutive year was (a) Finland (b) Denmark (c) Iceland (d) Switzerland
- Q11.** The World Happiness Report is produced under the auspices of (a) the OECD (b) the UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network (c) the World Health Organization (d) the United Nations Development Programme
- Q12.** The Global Innovation Index is published by (a) the World Economic Forum (b) UNCTAD (c) the World Intellectual Property Organization (d) the World Bank
- Q13.** The Economic Survey 2025-26 placed real GDP growth for 2025-26, in the First Advance Estimates, at (a) 6.5% (b) 6.9% (c) 7.4% (d) 8.2%
- Q14.** India's national accounts base year has been revised to (a) 2017-18 (b) 2022-23 (c) 2011-12 (d) 2020-21
- Q15.** The Periodic Labour Force Survey is now published (a) monthly, as well as quarterly and annually (b) annually only (c) quarterly only (d) once in five years

6.3 Science, space and technology

Q16. NISAR is significant as (a) India's first Mars mission (b) the first Indian reusable launch vehicle (c) the heaviest Indian communication satellite (d) the first joint ISRO–NASA satellite mission

Q17. NISAR is the first Earth observation satellite to use (a) dual-frequency L-band and S-band radar (b) optical hyperspectral imaging (c) a solar sail (d) a nuclear power source

Q18. The 2025 Nobel Prize in Physics was awarded for work on (a) attosecond light pulses (b) quantum entanglement (c) black hole formation (d) macroscopic quantum tunnelling and energy quantisation in an electric circuit

Q19. The 2025 Nobel Prize in Chemistry was awarded for (a) click chemistry (b) quantum dots (c) metal-organic frameworks (d) lithium-ion batteries

Q20. The 2025 Nobel Prize in Literature was awarded to (a) Han Kang (b) László Krasznahorkai (c) Annie Ernaux (d) Abdulrazak Gurnah

Q21. The 2025 Nobel Peace Prize was awarded to (a) Narges Mohammadi (b) María Corina Machado (c) Nihon Hidankyo (d) the World Food Programme

Q22. The 2025 Nobel Prize in Economic Sciences recognised work explaining (a) auction theory (b) experimental approaches to poverty alleviation (c) how innovation drives sustained growth (d) contract theory

6.4 Defence and security

Q23. Operation Sindoor was (a) a joint naval exercise with France (b) a disaster relief operation (c) an anti-piracy deployment (d) Indian strikes on terror infrastructure in Pakistan

Q24. The beyond-visual-range air-to-air missile shown on Indian Air Force Rafale aircraft in the Operation Sindoor footage was the (a) Meteor (b) Astra Mk-1 (c) R-77 (d) AIM-120

Q25. The Defence Acquisition Council cleared a deal for how many Rafale aircraft, of which 90 are to be built in India? (a) 36 (b) 26 (c) 97 (d) 114

Q26. The SCALP, for which a deal with France was negotiated, is a (a) long-range air-launched cruise missile (b) surface-to-air missile (c) anti-tank guided missile (d) heavyweight torpedo

Q27. Republic Day 2026 was India's (a) seventy-fifth (b) seventy-sixth (c) seventy-seventh (d) seventy-eighth

6.5 Awards, sport and persons

Q28. The total number of Padma Awards announced for 2026 was (a) 113 (b) 131 (c) 139 (d) 106

Q29. Of these, the number of Padma Vibhushan awards was (a) three (b) four (c) five (d) seven

Q30. The actor on whom the Padma Vibhushan was conferred posthumously in 2026 was (a) Manoj Kumar (b) Dharmendra (c) Mammooty (d) Shatrughan Sinha

Q31. India's position in the medal table at the 2026 Commonwealth Games was (a) first (b) second (c) third (d) fourth

Q32. India's total medal count at those Games was (a) 39 (b) 61 (c) 26 (d) 55

Q33. The 2026 Commonwealth Games were held at (a) Glasgow (b) Birmingham (c) the Gold Coast (d) Victoria

Q34. The sport in which India won the most gold medals at those Games was (a) wrestling (b) boxing (c) shooting (d) weightlifting

Q35. In the final of the ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2026, India defeated (a) Australia (b) England (c) New Zealand (d) South Africa

7. Answers and Explanations

7.1 International

Q	Ans	Explanation
1	b	Belém , Brazil. (a) Baku hosted COP29 and (c) Dubai COP28 — a sequence question in disguise
2	d	The Global Mutirão decision. Distinguish it from the Belém Declaration , a separate voluntary instrument led by Colombia — §1.1's trap
3	a	The tenth anniversary, the Paris Agreement having been adopted in 2015
4	c	Johannesburg , 22–23 November 2025
5	a	The first African country to chair the G20
6	c	The United States , with the summit at Miami
7	d	Ubuntu
8	b	The Double Contributions Convention , both in force on 15 July 2026. (a) is a different instrument entirely — a DCC coordinates social security contributions , not tax

7.2 Reports and indices

Q	Ans	Explanation
9	d	116th , up from 118th. (b) is last year's rank, which is the standard distractor for any ranking question
10	a	Finland , for the ninth consecutive year
11	b	The UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network . (d) UNDP publishes the Human Development Report — two UN-linked bodies, two different reports
12	c	WIPO . (a) the WEF publishes the Global Competitiveness and Gender Gap reports — F10.1 §2.2's first trap
13	c	7.4% in the First Advance Estimates. (d) 8.2% is a single quarter , Q2 of 2025-26 — the stem names the annual estimate
14	b	2022-23
15	a	Monthly , as well as quarterly and annually

7.3 Science, space and technology

Q	Ans	Explanation
16	d	The first joint ISRO–NASA satellite mission
17	a	Dual-frequency L-band and S-band radar — the technical first, distinct from the institutional first in Q16. Both are asked
18	d	Macroscopic quantum tunnelling and energy quantisation in an electric circuit — the basis of superconducting qubits. (a) was the 2023 prize and (c) the 2020 prize
19	c	Metal-organic frameworks . (b) quantum dots was 2023 and (d) lithium-ion batteries 2019
20	b	László Krasznahorkai , the second Hungarian laureate after Imre Kertész. (a) and (c) are recent laureates offered as distractors
21	b	María Corina Machado . (a) was the 2023 laureate and (c) the 2024 — again a sequence question
22	c	How innovation drives sustained growth — endogenous growth theory, which connects to F4.1 §3.2

7.4 Defence and security

Q	Ans	Explanation
23	d	Indian strikes on terror infrastructure in Pakistan , in May 2025
24	a	The Meteor . (b) Astra is India's indigenous BVR missile and was also used, but the footage that ended the speculation showed the Meteor
25	d	114 , with 90 to be built in India and 50% indigenous content. (a) 36 is the earlier Rafale contract — the superseded number
26	a	A long-range air-launched cruise missile
27	c	The seventy-seventh

7.5 Awards, sport and persons

Q	Ans	Explanation
28	b	131 , including two duo cases counted as one each
29	c	Five Padma Vibhushan, with 13 Padma Bhushan and 113 Padma Shri. (a) 113 in the previous question's options is the Padma Shri count — the components offered as the whole
30	b	Dharmendra , received by Hema Malini
31	d	Fourth , behind Australia, England and Canada
32	a	39 — 13 gold, 17 silver, 9 bronze. India's lowest tally in 24 years
33	a	Glasgow . (b) Birmingham hosted 2022 and (c) the Gold Coast 2018
34	b	Boxing — 7 of India's 13 golds, and the most by any nation in boxing at a single Games
35	c	New Zealand , by 96 runs — India's third title, first successful defence, and first win as host

THINK LIKE UPSC · THE THREE SHAPES IN THIS BANK

1. **The previous edition.** Q1 (Baku, Dubai), Q9 (118th), Q18, Q19, Q21 (earlier Nobel citations), Q25 (36 Rafales), Q33 (Birmingham, Gold Coast). **Seven of thirty-five questions** offer the correct answer to *last year's* version of the same question. For any recurring event — a COP, an index, a Nobel, a Games — **the distractors are its own history**
2. **The institutional first against the technical first.** Q16 and Q17 are the same satellite asked twice: *joint ISRO–NASA* and *dual-frequency radar*. Where an achievement has two distinct claims to novelty, expect both
3. **The component offered as the total.** Q28 and Q29 — 131 against 113, and 5 against 13. This is the same pattern as F4.1's Rajya Sabha strength: **the examiner offers a real number from the same table**

8. One-Minute Revision

ONE-MINUTE REVISION · CHAPTER F10.4

COP30 Belém, Brazil, 10–21 Nov 2025, closing **22 Nov** · **"GLOBAL MUTIRÃO"** decision · **10th anniversary of the Paris Agreement** · **tripling of adaptation finance** · **NO fossil-fuel phase-out in the main decision** · a separate **BELÉM DECLARATION** led by **COLOMBIA** did address transition · also **global adaptation indicators**, a **just transition mechanism**, a **Gender Action Plan**, a three-year trade dialogue · **2024 warmest year**, about **1.55 °C**

G20 Johannesburg, 22–23 Nov 2025 · **South Africa the FIRST AFRICAN chair** (Dec 2024 – Nov 2025) · **UBUNTU** · condemned **terrorism**, recognised **Digital Public Infrastructure**, women-led development · **2026 presidency: UNITED STATES**, at **Miami**

TRADE AND MOBILITY CETA signed **24 July 2025**, in force **15 July 2026**, **30 chapters** · **DCC** in force **15 July 2026**, **60-month exemption**, **contributions not benefits** · **India–EU FTA** concluded **27 Jan 2026**

WORLD HAPPINESS 2026 India **116th** (from 118th) of **147** · **Finland 1st for the 9th year** · India behind **Nepal and Pakistan** · published by the **UN SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT SOLUTIONS NETWORK**

OTHER RANKS — FROM A COMPILATION, VERIFY **GII 38th** · **CPI 96th** · **EPI 176 of 177** · **Henley 75th** · **Terrorism 13th**. **The PUBLISHER is durable, the RANK is not**

STATISTICS growth **7.4% (FAE)**, **6.8–7.2%** projected · base year **2022-23** · **PLFS now monthly** · unemployment about **5.1%**, **LFPR 54–55%**, female **LFPR** about **34%** · **TFR below replacement**

NISAR launched **30 July 2025** (two days before the window) on **GSLV-F16** · **first joint ISRO–NASA mission** · **first dual-frequency L + S band radar** Earth observation satellite · **NASA's 12 m unfurlable antenna** on an Indian bus and Indian vehicle

NOBEL 2025 Medicine Brunkow, Ramsdell, Sakaguchi — **peripheral immune tolerance** · **Physics** Clarke, Devoret, Martinis — **macroscopic quantum tunnelling** in a circuit, the basis of **superconducting qubits** · **Chemistry** Kitagawa, Robson, Yaghi — **metal-organic frameworks** · **Literature** **László Krasznahorkai** (2nd Hungarian, after Kertész 2002) · **Peace** **María Corina Machado** · **Economics** Mokyr, Aghion, Howitt — **innovation-driven growth**

DEFENCE **Operation Sindoor, May 2025** — strikes on terror infrastructure in Pakistan · **Rafale, Su-30MKI, Tejas; Meteor, BrahMos, SCALP, S-400** · **IAF confirmed Meteor in Jan 2026** · **Republic Day 2026 = 77th**, 'Sindoor' flypast · **DAC cleared ~€32 bn for 114 RAFALE, 90 made in India, 50% indigenous** · **SCALP ~€300 mn, 100–150 missiles** · **Mission Sudarshan Chakra** air defence · **clearances are not deliveries**

PADMA 2026 131 awards (2 duos) = **5 Vibhushan + 13 Bhushan + 113 Shri** · **19 women, 6 foreign/NRI, 16 posthumous** · **Dharmendra — Padma Vibhushan, POSTHUMOUS** ·

announced Republic Day, 66 conferred 25 May 2026

T20 WORLD CUP 2026 India beat **New Zealand by 96 runs, 8 March 2026** · India's **third** title · **first to defend** · **first host to win** · next edition **2028**, Australia and New Zealand

CWG 2026 GLASGOW — the 23rd Games India **4th** with **39 medals: 13 G, 17 S, 9 B** · **lowest in 24 years**, first below 50 since 1998 · Australia (171/70), England (110/29), Canada (62/19) ahead · **BOXING best: 10 medals, 7 gold**, most by any nation in a single Games · **Tejaswin Shankar** first Indian decathlon medal · **Gulveer Singh** first Indian with two athletics medals at one Games · **the Games CLOSED 2 AUGUST 2026, one day after the cut-off**

PERSONS VP **C.P. Radhakrishnan** · CJI **Surya Kant** · CPFC **Ramesh Krishnamurthi** · Labour Minister **Mansukh Mandaviya** · RBI Governor **Sanjay Malhotra** · 16th FC **Arvind Panagariya** · NITI CEO **B.V.R. Subrahmanyam** · Census Commissioner **Mritunjay Kumar Narayan**

9. Five-Minute Wall Sheet

FIVE-MINUTE WALL SHEET · CHAPTER F10.4

COP30 = BELÉM · "GLOBAL MUTIRÃO" · PARIS AT TEN · NO FOSSIL-FUEL PHASE-OUT IN THE MAIN TEXT

THE BELÉM *DECLARATION* IS A SEPARATE COLOMBIAN-LED INSTRUMENT. DO NOT CONFUSE THE TWO

G20 = JOHANNESBURG · SOUTH AFRICA THE FIRST AFRICAN CHAIR · UBUNTU · 2026 = USA

CETA AND THE DCC BOTH LIVE 15 JULY 2026

HAPPINESS: INDIA 116th OF 147 · FINLAND 1st FOR THE 9th YEAR · PUBLISHED BY UN SDSN

LEARN THE PUBLISHER, NOT THE RANK

GII = WIPO · HDR = UNDP · GENDER GAP = WEF

NISAR: FIRST JOINT ISRO-NASA · FIRST DUAL-FREQUENCY L+S BAND RADAR

NOBEL 2025: TUNNELLING (PHYSICS) · MOFs (CHEMISTRY) · IMMUNE TOLERANCE (MEDICINE)

KRASZNAHORKAI · MACHADO · MOKYR, AGHION, HOWITT

OPERATION SINDOOR, MAY 2025 · METEOR CONFIRMED JAN 2026 · RD 2026 = 77th

114 RAFALE CLEARED, 90 MADE IN INDIA. 36 WAS THE OLD CONTRACT

A CLEARANCE IS NOT A DELIVERY

PADMA 2026: $131 = 5 + 13 + 113$ · DHARMENDRA POSTHUMOUS

T20 WC 2026: BEAT NEW ZEALAND BY 96 · THIRD TITLE · FIRST DEFENCE · FIRST HOST WIN

CWG GLASGOW: 4th, 39 MEDALS (13-17-9) · BOXING 7 GOLD · CLOSED 2 AUG, ONE DAY PAST THE CUT-OFF

FOR ANY RECURRING EVENT, THE DISTRACTORS ARE ITS OWN HISTORY

IF YOU ARE SPENDING LONGER ON SPORT THAN ON THE PUBLISHER TABLE, YOU ARE REVISING THE WRONG THING

ONE LINE FOR THE INTERVIEW The instructive feature of COP30 was the gap between what the conference could formally decide and what a coalition was willing to declare beside it —

the Mutirão decision carried the finance package but no fossil-fuel commitment, which is a fair summary of where multilateral climate negotiation has arrived a decade after Paris.

ACTION · THE DOSSIER IS COMPLETE

Module 10 now runs to four chapters: F10.1 the system, **F10.2** the standing dossier, and **F10.3 and F10.4** the twelve-month record to 1 August 2026.

Three things to do with it:

1. **Read F10.3 §1 twice.** It is the part of the dossier closest to the post, and the part no general compilation will give you
2. **Start your own monthly register tonight**, per F10.1 §3.2. This dossier ends on 1 August 2026; **the examination does not**, and everything after the cut-off is yours to collect
3. **Diarise F10.1 §4's twelve-item sweep** for the fortnight before the paper. Several figures here — the repo rate, the forex reserves, the unemployment rate, the wage ceiling — will have moved by then